

Medford School Committee

Committee of the Whole

April 30, 2014

Minutes

The meeting was called to order at 7:00 p.m. by Vice Chairperson John Falco Jr. Members present were Ann Marie Cugno, Erin DiBenedetto, George Scarpelli and Robert Emmett Skerry Jr. (5 present and 2 absent). Also in attendance were Superintendent Roy Belson, Deputy Superintendent Beverly Nelson, Assistant Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Director of Humanities Nicole Chiesa, Director of Mathematics/Science Carolyn Joy, Principals Jacob Edwards, Diane Guarino, Paul D'Alleva, Kathy Kay and Kevin Andrews. Also MHS Crew Coaches Ed McCormack and Nick Wright.

All rose to salute the Flag.

Chairperson Falco stated that the purposes of the meeting were to:

- Consider the naming of two school libraries
- Receive and discuss the ELA and mathematics pre budget reports.

Mr. Falco then asked the Superintendent to begin the discussion.

Superintendent Belson asked the Chairperson to invoke a suspension of the rules to hear a matter regarding the high school crew that came up unexpectedly.

The committee agreed to hear the issue.

The high school crew was invited to participate in a select competition in Connecticut on Sunday, May 4, 2014. Forty students will be participating. They will travel to Connecticut by coach bus for a 9:00 a.m. meet and return to Medford at approximately 7:00 p.m. on the same day. They will be under the supervision of the two coaches. Several parents are expected to drive down in their own vehicles.

After discussion on requisite safety issues and expectations with the coaches the School Committee voted to approve the trip (5 yes –0 no –2 absent).

The Committee then heard a presentation from Principals Diane Guarino and Jake Edwards (see attached) on behalf of the faculty, students and staff to name the library at the John J. McGlynn School for Helen Lennox McGlynn. On the motion of member Cugno seconded by member Skerry the school committee voted to endorse the naming (5 yes –0 no –2 absent) and refer the matter to the regular meeting of May 5, 2014 for a formal vote.

The Committee then heard Principal Paul D'Alleva present a request (see attached) on behalf of the Andrews faculty, staff and students to name the Andrews Library after longtime teacher Pauline Walker. On the motion of member Cugno seconded by member Skerry the school committee voted to endorse the naming (5 yes –0 no –2 absent) and refer the matter to the regular meeting of May 5, 2014 for a formal vote.

The Committee then heard the pre budget presentations on English Language Arts from director Nicole Chiesa (see attached report).

The report highlighted the major achievements and funding goals of the department. The report was well received and the Director was thanked for her work this year. Some additional points made in response to questions were:

- Books and materials are shared with the vocational school
- Vocational staff attend high school meetings of the department
- New E-Readers are being piloted with good early success
- The Journeys Literacy program has been well received
- Professional development in ongoing and attendance is good. Some work is done online.
- The District Review Team was impressed with the curriculum in ELA.

The School Committee then heard from Mathematics Director Carolyn Joy.

The full report is attached to these minutes.

This year the district has been selectively piloting two different mathematics series: Go Math and Envisions.

Both of these series are aligned with the Common Core.

Director Joy informed the committee that the department will be surveying teachers and parents on the two programs this month.

Principals Kay and Andrews described their experience with the programs.

The Superintendent made it clear that any new elementary program needed to be user friendly. Fidelity of implementation was essential. Also that he wanted to reduce the yearly cost of consumables.

The cost of any new program must be reasonable and payable over a 2-3 year period.

Director Joy also discussed the status of middle school and high school books and materials. There is a need to do some updating of graphic calculators.

She also asked that a dedicated computer lab be reserved for the department at the high school. The Superintendent noted that this was possible.

The School Committee thanked Director Joy for her work and looked forward to further details.

On the motion of Member Skerry seconded by Member Cugno the meeting was adjourned at 8:52 p.m.

Respectfully Submitted,

John Falco
Vice Chairperson